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The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388

T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3

MEETING CALENDAR

MARCH			APRIL		
4	Juniors Board of Governors meeting Meeting & Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm	1	Juniors Board of Governors meeting Meeting & Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm
5	Sat. Boursette & Library Day -- Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:00 am	2	Sat. Boursette & Library Day -- Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:00 am
11	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm	8	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm
18	Juniors Program: "S.I.L. & C.I.L." By Warren Crain	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	15	Juniors Program: "Income Tax" by John Clay	6:15 pm 7:30 pm
25	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm	24	Happy Easter	
17	Happy St. Patrick's Day		29	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm

5/06 - Jrs, BOG&G, Show&Tell : 3/05 - Sat.Boursette : 5/13 - Auction : 5/20 - Jrs, Program : 5/27 - Bourse

St Patrick's Day - Mar 17 (Scott #1705)

Easter - Apr 24 (Zazzle)

Editors' Corner

As those of you who attended the February 11th auction know, we are experimenting with a slightly different way to run the auction. Instead of keeping the sold lots on a table behind the display tables, they are being handed directly to the buyer as soon as the bidding for each lot is finished. After the auction finishes, the buyers just go to the Treasurer to pay for their lots.

What this is intended to do is to remove the congestion at the table where the lots were being kept, and to keep each buyer's lots from becoming mixed in with other buyer's lots (which has happened, unfortunately). It will also mean that the buyers will have less hassle at the end of the auction. Since they will already have their purchases, they will only need to pay for them.

We will continue this way until we can decide whether this is working, is an improvement, and suits our needs.

We hope that our members will come to the auctions, enjoy buying and selling stamps, and let us know how we are doing.

Lea Senghaas and Dora Roberts

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta & Richard Spies

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
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San Antonio, Tx 78209
Or email either of us.
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Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	John Clay
Vice President:	Nelda Greer
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	Judy Grant
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneer:	John Clay
Librarian:	Richard Rose

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	John Clay
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Jane K Fohn
One year term:	Charles Shelby
Two year term:	Skip Swinney
Parliamentarian:	Bob Joyce
Honorary Board Member	Richard Spies

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Eire Philatelic Association:	Patrick J. Ryan
Texas Philatelic Association:	Robert J. Joyce
APS Circuit Books	John Clay

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities, and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourse, and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

Please wait until the end of the auction to pay for your purchases. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks are acceptable, made out to S.A.P.A.

Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Our president and his lovely wife have gone on vacation to get warm. They will be back, and will tell us how nice it was in the sun.

Lea Senghaas, Editor

MEMBERSHIP INFORMATION

We wish to extend a warm welcome to our newest member, Kurt F. Kneeland, who collects US plateblocks.

Dora Roberts, SAPA Membership Chair

Program Notes

March 18— "Stamps I Like & Covers I Like" by Warren Crain Warren assures me that he has all new material to dazzle us with for the stamps and covers he likes. He always fascinates us and educates us. I am looking forward to his program.

April 15— "Income Tax" by John Clay

John is being VERY mysterious with me about the contents of his program. I have tried to get some notes from him—no luck. Either he has no idea what he is going to do, or he is going to give us a "double whammy!" Keep in mind that he is an "Enroll Agent" for the IRS and has worked for H & R Block for many years.

OOOOOOOPS!!! I suggest that you already have your taxes filed by the time you come to the meeting on this program night. Who knows what John's program will hold and how that applies to philately. I, for one, am looking forward to knowing what he has to say.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

MAR 4-5 TX PRECANCEL CLUB SPRING ROUND-UP Spring auction & bourse of the Texas Precancel Club at the College Station Conference Center, 1300 George Bush Dr, College Station, TX. Hours: Fri 9am-10pm, Sat 8am-5pm. Auction on Sat at 2pm. Lunch provided to those who sign up before 10am each day. Contact: Katherine Foster, kh.foster@hotmail.com

APR 9-10 TSDA HOUSTON STAMP FAIR Bourse at the Holiday Inn Near the Galleria, 3131 West Loop Frwy (I-610 South at Richmond Ave exit), Houston, TX. Hours: Sat 10am-5pm, Sun 10am-4pm.

APR 15-17 TEXPEX 2011 The 115th annual exhibition and convention of the Texas Philatelic Association at the Doubletree Hotel Dallas Near the Galleria, 4099 Valley View Ln. (I-635 at Midway exit), Dallas Texas. Show features World Series of Philately exhibits, bourse, youth booth, USPS substation, cacheted cover and show cancellation. TPA meetings scheduled on Saturday as follows: Foundation Trustees at 8:00am; Annual Meeting at 9:30am; Board of Directors at 10:00am. Hours: Fri & Sat 10am-6pm, Sun 10am-4pm. Contact: Tom Koch, tkoch@utdallas.edu; (972) 883-4951; (972) 883-2473.

FRED SAYS...

Beginning in January the online version of The American Philatelist (http://www.stamps.org/Services/ser_AP.htm) has new features, including an enhanced search feature, printer-friendly text version, and a translation function. Look at February's Issue of the AP and read about "The AP & You - The New Online Version & More." *(This info is from the APS February Member Newsletter)*

The American Philatelic Society has some excellent advice about your Philatelic Estate, and how to handle your collection. Go to http://www.stamps.org/index.htm, click on Services/Estate Advice.

The Smithsonian National Postal Museum offers a number of interesting and informative collections online at Arago: People, Postage & the Post, at http://arago.si.edu/ . Currently there are almost 60 exhibits available for viewing online. Themes listed are: New!; Curator's Choice; America's History; People & Culture; Just For Fun; Topical Interests; Philatelic Collection; Around the World; Events; and Teachers & Students.

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EASTER GREETINGS

Bring in your SAPA Membership Card, or a Philatex cover with your name and address on it, and receive a **10%** discount off all stamps! Offer good April 1 - April 30.

ABC Stamps is located on the corner of Broadway and Terrell Rd, across from La Madeleine. It is at the side of the building facing Terrell Rd. Parking is in the rear, or behind La Madeleine.

Program Notes January 21, 2011
"Chocolate!!!" by Nelda Greer

Well, you can see from the picture at left that Nelda was ready to wow us with her program on Chocolate. It started with her and Harry setting up a coffee urn with lots and lots of chocolate cookies, etc. on the table with the coffee. It looks like Brother Loch got "caught" partaking of the delicious nectar.

We even had to add an extra table (shown below) to have enough room for all the "moths" drawn to the "chocolate attraction."

James & Luke Keller, Lea Senghaas, Sam Rodgers, Harry Greer, Marilyn & Rich Barnes, Eric Shepherd, Jeff White

The history of chocolate begins with a tree name ***Theobroma ("food of the gods") cacao*** (named in 1753 by Linnaeus, a Swedish scientist). Tradition used to hold that chocolate began around 500BCE with the Mayans, however more recent archeological findings show that the Olmecs used cacao over 3500 years ago.

Harry Greer, Bob Joyce, Jane Fohn

There are four steps to producing cacao nibs—fermentation, drying, roasting and winnowing. Then the nibs could be ground into chocolate. The Olmecs, Mayans and Aztecs added chili pepper to a bitter liquid made from the cacao beans. The liquid would be poured from one container to another to make a frothy foam. Nelda did not share a frothy foamed liquid with us, but she had her helper, Dr. Harry, parcel out portions of the nibs and chocolate pepper cakes as samples of the various early usages (shown at right).

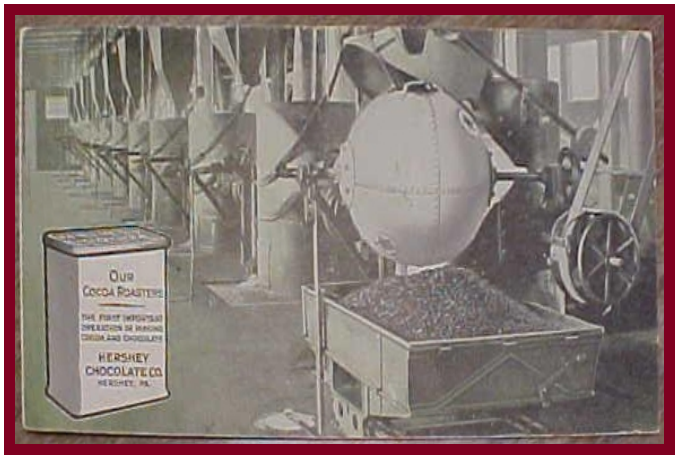
In August of 1502, Christopher Columbus and his fourth voyage crew were the first Europeans to see the cacao beans. They noticed that the natives valued these "almonds" as the sailors called them. The beans were quite valuable because the Mayans used them for trading.

Although Cortez was told that drinking the liquid would give energy, wisdom and enhanced sexuality, he said that the taste was something only fit for pigs and not human consumption. Although Hernando Cortez was credited for taking cacao from the New World to Spain, current historical research theorizes that the Jesuits and the Dominicans brought chocolate to Spain and then to Italy and France. Spices, sugar and cinnamon were added to the drink to make it palatable for European tastes.

In fact, in France, chocolate was a drink reserved for aristocrats at court. In England it was available in coffee-shops. Some of these coffee-shops became private clubs. The most famous of these clubs was White's Chocolate House. It became quite a gentleman's club —gambling, politics, etc. At left is a cover mailed to someone from White's Club.

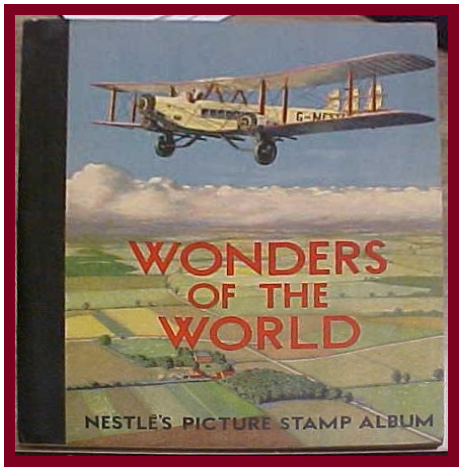
James Baker began making chocolate in 1765 in Massachusetts. In 1819, Francouis Louis Callier opened the first Swiss Chocolate factory on Lake Geneva. Six years late Phillipe Suchard built machines including the world's first chocolate mixer and started making candy (see color postcards next page top left).

Milton Hershey, a Mennonite, made caramels in his Lancaster, Pennsylvania candy factory. In 1893, he saw a German chocolate making demonstration at the Columbian Exposition. He purchased the entire exhibit (upper right) and had it shipped to Lancaster where he began making chocolate and building a town for his employees (see postcards at right).



Poster stamps (shown left) are labels that advertise products and events. They originated in the mid-19th century and became a popular collectable. They are considered Cinderellas, but are gradually enjoying a comeback. Chocolate companies attached them to envelopes and invoices.

The biggest companies like Tobler and Nestle issued their own poster stamp albums (shown at right).



The souvenir sheet at left depicts the whole history of chocolate in a "nutshell."

Once again, Nelda has left everyone staggering with knowledge and good times. It was a pleasure for all present. It leaves me wondering what she will give us next to "mesmerize" us. Thanks, Nelda, it was a wonderful night.

Yours in Philately, Pat Richmond